

Bürgeramt Survival Script

Register your existence in Germany — walk in nervous, walk out angemeldet. Copy these exact lines; a real clerk actually says them back.

Before you go — checklist

Show up with all of this in one folder and you'll be out in ten minutes. Show up missing one paper and they send you home — so pack the folder the night before.

der Reisepass / der Personalausweis

passport / national ID card

Bring the original, not a photo. "der" = masculine, so it's mein Reisepass (my passport).

die Wohnungsgeberbestätigung

landlord's confirmation that you moved in

The #1 paper everyone forgets. Your landlord (der Wohnungsgeber) signs it. No Bestätigung = no Anmeldung. Get it before you go.

der Mietvertrag

the rental contract

Bring it as backup even if the form is filled in — sometimes they want to see it. Say it ≈ "MEET-fer-trahk."

das ausgefüllte Anmeldeformular

the completed registration form

Print it from your city's website and fill it in at home in pen. ausgefüllt = "filled in." Doing it beforehand skips the line stress.

der Termin (die Terminbestätigung)

your appointment (the appointment confirmation)

Most Bürgerämter are appointment-only. Screenshot or print the confirmation email — you'll need the time. Without one, you may be turned away.

At the desk — say this, in order

Four lines, in this exact order, carry you through the whole visit. Don't improvise — just read them off. (≈ is a rough English-sounds pronunciation, not real phonetics.)

Guten Tag, ich möchte mich anmelden.

Hello, I'd like to register.

≈ "GOO-ten tahk, ish MERKH-te mish AN-mel-den." The 'ch' in möchte is soft (like in ich) — gentler than an English 'sh.' This is the magic opener — "sich anmelden" is exactly the verb on the form.

Ich habe einen Termin um 10 Uhr.

I have an appointment at 10 o'clock.

≈ "ish HAH-be EYE-nen ter-MEEN um tsehn oor." Swap 10 for your time. "einen" because der Termin is masculine.

Hier ist meine Wohnungsgeberbestätigung.

Here is my landlord's confirmation.

≈ "heer ist MY-ne VOH-nungs-geh-ber-be-shtay-ti-gung." Hand it over as you say it. Long word, but they hear it 50 times a day — just slide the paper across.

Brauchen Sie noch etwas?

Do you need anything else?

≈ "BROW-khen zee nokh ET-vas?" The perfect polite closer — it shows you're organized and lets the clerk ask for the last paper before you leave.

If they ask you...

The clerk will fire a few quick questions. Here's the likely question and the exact short answer you give back — beginner-safe, and what a native actually says.

— **Seit wann wohnen Sie hier? → Seit dem ersten Mai.**

— Since when have you lived here? → Since the first of May.

Just give the move-in date (your Einzugsdatum). Swap in your date, e.g. Seit dem fünfzehnten Juni.

— **Wohnen Sie allein? → Ja, ich wohne allein. / Nein, mit meiner Familie.**

— Do you live alone? → Yes, I live alone. / No, with my family.

"allein" = alone. "mit meiner Familie" = with my family. Pick the true one — that's the whole answer.

— **Sprechen Sie Deutsch? → Ein bisschen. Sprechen Sie Englisch?**

— Do you speak German? → A little. Do you speak English?

"Ein bisschen" (≈ "eyn BISS-yen") = a little — honest and disarming. Flipping the question back is totally normal and they often switch.

— **Können Sie das bitte wiederholen?**

— Could you please repeat that?

Your lifeline when they talk fast. ≈ "KER-nen zee das BIT-te VEE-der-hoh-len?" Use it freely — clerks are used to it and slow down.

— **Entschuldigung, ich verstehe das nicht.**

— Sorry, I don't understand that.

No shame in this one. ≈ "ent-SHOOL-di-gung, ish fer-SHTAY-e das nisht." It buys you a slower, simpler version every time.

Words on the form

These are the actual field labels on the Anmeldeformular. Know the seven and the page stops being scary — der/die/das matters because it tells you the gender you'll see all over the form.

die Anmeldung

registration

The whole thing you're doing today. die = feminine. The verb is "sich anmelden" (to register yourself).

die Wohnung

the apartment / home

die — handy rule: words ending in -ung are almost always die (die Wohnung, die Anmeldung, die Bestätigung).

der Familienname

surname / family name

der = masculine. This is your last name — goes in the box marked Familienname or Name.

der Vorname

first name

der. "vor" = before, so literally the "before-name" — the name that comes before the family name.

das Geburtsdatum

date of birth

das = neuter. Written day.month.year in Germany: 05.08.1995. "Geburt" = birth, "Datum" = date.

die Staatsangehörigkeit

nationality / citizenship

die — ends in -keit, and -keit nouns are feminine. You write your nationality as an adjective, e.g. türkisch, britisch, amerikanisch.

das Einzugsdatum

move-in date

das. The day you moved into the Wohnung — same date as the "Seit wann" question above. "Einzug" = moving in.

SEND · SAVE

Save this to your phone before your appointment, then SEND it to the friend who still hasn't done their Anmeldung — Germany says you don't officially exist until you do. Want the printable one-page version? DM the word "BÜRGERAMT" and I'll send it over. More survival German: @genaugerman